



Brown bear

Spanning the Northern Hemisphere, brown bears have the widest range of any bear species. On the Pacific coast of North America, they fish for salmon.

Polar bear

This bear eats meat and little else. It specializes in hunting for Arctic seals, and regularly swims more than 30 miles (50 km) in search of food.

American black bear

The most populous bear species is an excellent opportunist, eating seasonal nuts and berries, scavenging carrion, and even raiding human garbage or stores of food.

Andean bear

This shy bear is mainly a plant-eater. It prefers the remote rainforests of the Andes Mountains, though it will descend in search of food and has been found in many different habitats, including thorny, dry forests and even coastal deserts.

Grizzly bear

The fur of brown bears varies in color across their range. Some regional populations in North America have silver-tipped, or grizzly, hair.

ANIMALS IN DANGER

Andean bear

⚠ IUCN status: vulnerable

📊 Population estimate: 2,500–10,000

Polar bear

⚠ IUCN status: vulnerable

📊 Population estimate: 22,000–31,000

Sloth bear

⚠ IUCN status: vulnerable

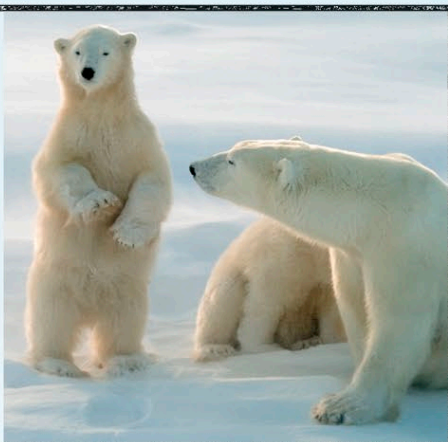
📊 Population estimate: unknown

Range of habitats

Bears are found across Europe, Asia, North America, and in parts of South America. The largest bear species—polar and brown bears—live in the cold north. Further south, smaller bears with smaller ranges live in the tropics.

Adapting to climate

Polar bears are perfectly adapted to life in their Arctic habitat. Their thick fur is made of hollow hairs that trap warmth close to the body. Even their paw pads are furry, with tiny bumps to help grip slippery ice. Their small ears and tail minimize heat loss. Loss of their unique habitat is putting these bears at risk, as climate change reduces the sea ice on which they depend.



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